How to Read This Analysis for Business Value

First-Principles Analysis

15 October 2026

Professional Strategic Analysis

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How to Read This Analysis for Business Value

A first-principles analysis is long because it shows its work. This guide says where to look, and in what order.

Start at the Answer

Read the `## Answer` block first. In the reader report it is headed Executive Summary. It has three parts: the "Recommendation" says what to do; the "Band (from §6)" says how sure the analysis is, HIGH, MEDIUM or LOW; and "Would change it" names the evidence that would move the band or the advice. Each line names the chain behind it, such as (chain C2), so any claim you doubt can be traced.

Map to your role

- **Decision owner:** read the Answer, then the "Conclusion", above all its "Recommended approach" and "Trade-offs acknowledged".
- **Operator:** read the "Derivation Chains" to see how each step follows from facts, then "Abandoned Reasoning" to see which routes were tried and why they fail.
- **Risk and compliance:** read the "Assumptions Table". A row typed `current constraint` holds only until something changes, and its verdict says when. A row typed `untested belief` is unproven. Then look in the "Ground Truths" for any id written as `GT-N?`: that fact was not verified.

If a persona view for your role sits beside the report, it summarises what the analysis offers you and points to the recommendation; the six sections remain the source.

Audit path for high-stakes decisions

Follow one claim back to its evidence:

1. Pick a claim in the "Conclusion" and note the chain it names.
2. Find that chain in the "Derivation Chains" and read each step.
3. Check every ground truth the chain starts from in the "Ground Truths", and whether it carries a `?`.
4. Check each assumption the chain marks with `[Assumes: A-N]` against the "Assumptions Table" and its verdict.
5. In the working file (analysis-), read the "Self-Audit Gate" verdicts and the structured summary at the end of the appendix: how the analysis scored itself.

What business value looks like here

- **"Success criteria"** in the "Problem Essence": the measurable outcomes that would show the problem is solved. Use them as your acceptance test.
- **"expiry conditions"** on `current constraint` rows: the events that should trigger a review.
- **Each "Dead End"** in "Abandoned Reasoning": an option you need not fund again, with the reason it fails.
- **"Would change it":** the evidence that would change the recommendation; if it is cheap, get it first. The formal falsification test stays in the working file's process output.

When to act and when to dig

Act when the Answer's band is HIGH and no ground truth the Conclusion rests on is marked `?`. Section 6's `**Pre-check:**` line lists those inputs under `?-marked`; its `Inputs ceiling` only caps the band, and the `**Confidence:**` line is the band itself.

Otherwise, treat "Would change it" as your evidence plan: gather that evidence before you commit. A MEDIUM or LOW `**Confidence:**` line names what holds the band down and what would lift it.

All files in this folder